

CHANDRA SHEKHAR

Assistant Professor

Department of Geography and Environmental Sustainability

University of Oklahoma

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RESEARCH FOCUS

Political economy; political sociology; organizational analysis; bureaucracy; social policy; social theory

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

University of Oklahoma, Norman, OK Aug. 2024–Present

Assistant Professor, Department of Geography and Environmental Sustainability

London School of Economics and Political Science, London, UK Oct. 2022–Aug. 2024

Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Social Policy

Harvard University, Cambridge, MA 2023–2024

Affiliate, Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, Research Cluster on Comparative Inequality and Inclusion

EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) 2022

Ph.D. Public Policy and Environmental Philosophy

Advisors: Janelle Knox-Hayes; Lawrence E. Susskind; Bish Sanyal; Sally Haslanger; Chappell Lawson; Asya Magazinnik

Georgia Institute of Technology 2010

M.S., Climate Change and Public Policy

Indian Institute of Science (IISc) 2007

M.S. (Engineering)

G.B. Pant University 2002

B.Tech. Mechanical Engineering

BOOK

Shekhar, Chandra. *The Logic of Corruption: Why It Persists and Why Reforms Fail*. Cambridge University Press (forthcoming August 2026).

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Knox-Hayes, J., Agarwal, S., Arango-Quiroga, J., Ashford, N., Birge, D., Carolini, G., **Shekhar, C.**, et al. (2025). The equitable resilience framework: an environmental justice strategy for community-led resilience planning. *World Development Perspectives*, 40, 100738.

Knox-Hayes, J., **Shekhar, C.**, Chun, J., Gowda, S., Karmakar, I., and Winer, R. (2023). The geographies, typologies, and trends of community-based organizations for solar energy in the United States. *Energy Research & Social Science*, 106, 103311.

Knox-Hayes, J., **Shekhar, C.**, and Chun, J. (2020). The role of values in shaping sustainable development perspectives and outcomes: A case study of Iceland. *Sustainable Development*, 29(2), 363–377.

PUBLICATIONS UNDER REVIEW

Shekhar, Chandra. The hierarchical production of corruption. Under review.

WORKING PAPERS

Shekhar, Chandra. Why are anti-corruption reforms difficult to implement? Evidence from India's state police bureaucracy.

Abstract: I examine the nature of linkages between grand corruption of senior officials and petty corruption of street officials in India's state police bureaucracy. Using a randomized response survey of 125 serving police officials, and in-depth semi-structured interviews of an additional 58 police officials and an ethnography of street vendors at an informal marketplace, I find evidence that these linkages are mutually reinforcing and are organized around the market for corruption in bureaucratic transfers. The mutually reinforcing nature of these linkages helps us answer the long-standing questions of the existence and persistence of corruption in government bureaucracies and why anti-corruption reforms are difficult to implement. These findings also explain why top-down anti-corruption reform strategies are not effective in cases of systematic corruption.

Shekhar, Chandra. A social choice-based approach to global justice.

Abstract: There are two major challenges in conceptualizing global justice. First, most theories of justice are based on some form of a social contract, which limits their applicability outside the sovereign boundaries of a state. These social contract-based theories need a Leviathan to enforce required rules, and we do not have a world government to play such a role. A difficulty that has engaged some authors is the contrast between the standard treatments of social choice for a sovereign nation and the essential demand for a multi-nation perspective for a reasonable treatment of global justice. Second, understanding the demands of liberty in the global context poses dilemmas. This paper introduces a possible new approach to global justice.

GRANTS AND AWARDS

U.S. Department of Energy Grant (Team Member)	2021–2024
MIT Martin Sustainability Fellowship	2021–2022
MIT Presidential Fellowship	2016–2017
MIT Center for International Studies Fellowship	2022
MIT Schwarzman College of Computing Social and Ethical Responsibilities of Computing Scholar	2021–2022
Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, MIT	2021
Graduate Student Travel Grant, MIT	2020
Merit Scholarship, Georgia Institute of Technology	2009–2010

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Oklahoma

Principles of Sustainability

London School of Economics and Political Science

Understanding Social (Dis)advantages

Global Social Policy and International Organizations

Understanding Social Policy Research

Research Methods in Social Policy

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (Teaching Assistant)

Microeconomics

Planning Economics

Quantitative Reasoning and Statistical Methods

Making Public Policy

Theory and Practice of Environmental Planning

Science, Technology and Public Policy

INVITED TALKS

Scheduled, Harvard University	Fall 2026
Scheduled, Massachusetts Institute of Technology	Fall 2026
University of Oklahoma Philosophy Department	Jan. 2025
University of Rhode Island Philosophy Department	Feb. 2024
Ahmedabad University	Apr. 2023
London School of Economics and Political Science	Nov. 2022
Syracuse University	Aug. 2022
Harvard University	Mar. 2022
Northern Arizona University	Apr. 2022
Indian Institute of Management	Mar. 2021
Indian Institute of Management	Oct. 2020

RESEARCH METHODS

Qualitative methods; comparative case studies; ethnography; survey methods

REFERENCES

Professor Janelle Knox-Hayes

Department of Urban Studies and Planning
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Cambridge, MA 02139, USA
(617) 452-2697
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Professor Sally Haslanger

Department of Linguistics and Philosophy
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